

REPLACE

SUPPORTS TERTIARY WHY

FOR WHAT-HOW · HOW-WHAT

The North Star One-Pager

The purpose of a project, captured once, usually extracted from the person who holds it, and kept visible for its whole life. **The why never has to be regenerated mid-flight.**

THE DRAIN

Projects demand their purpose repeatedly: in kickoffs, steering meetings, hallway challenges, and every new stakeholder conversation. For WHAT-HOW and HOW-WHAT profiles, producing that articulation fresh each time is a recurring drain, and the version produced under pressure is rarely the best one.

WHAT THIS TOOL DOES

The one-pager does the articulation exactly once, at the start, at full quality, often by borrowing it directly from the sponsor or WHY-primary who already holds it. From then on the answer to every purpose question is a pointer, not a performance. It is the difference between owning a script and improvising nightly.

What's on the page

- | | | |
|---|-------------------------|--|
| 1 | The change we're making | The before and after, two sentences. |
| 2 | Who it serves | The people whose situation improves, named plainly. |
| 3 | What success means | The observable result that ends the debate. |
| 4 | What we're not doing | The explicit exclusions. This line prevents more drift than any other. |
| 5 | The one-line answer | The sentence you give a stakeholder in an elevator. Memorize this one. |

HOW TO USE IT

- 1 **Extract, don't compose.** Interview the sponsor with the Vision Extraction guide. Their words, your page.
- 2 **Get it signed.** The sponsor confirms it in writing. Now it is authority, not just orientation.
- 3 **Post it everywhere the work lives.** Doc header, deck slide two, channel pin. Visibility is the mechanism.
- 4 **Point instead of re-answering.** When purpose gets questioned mid-project, the page answers. That is its whole job.

WHAT IT WON'T DO

A borrowed purpose only holds if the source had one; if the sponsor cannot fill the page, you have discovered a project risk far cheaper now than later. And the page is not a substitute for believing the work matters, it is a tool for not having to re-derive why, on demand, from a drained place.

IN THE KIT

North Star template

Sponsor sign-off block

Wall + slide formats

PAIRS WELL WITH

Tool 25 Vision Extraction Interview · **Tool 21** Five-Question Purpose Brief · **Tool 26** Quarterly Altitude Check